

Responding to a Technical Requirement: Scalability and High Availability

Scenario

Client Requirement

"The proposed system shall support 10,000 concurrent users while maintaining 99.9% uptime."

Objective

Demonstrate the ability to analyse a technical requirement, identify information gaps, collaborate with Subject Matter Experts (SMEs), and develop a clear and client-focused proposal response.

My Approach

Before writing the response, I analysed what the client was truly requesting beyond the explicit technical requirement.

I identified that the client was not only asking for scalability and availability, but was also seeking assurance that:

- The solution could handle business growth and peak workloads.
- The proposed architecture would be reliable and resilient.
- The vendor understood enterprise-grade system design.
- The proposed solution could be trusted to deliver the required service levels.

Instead of making assumptions, I identified the information that would typically be gathered from SMEs during the proposal development process.

Questions for the SME included:

- How will the proposed solution support 10,000 concurrent users?
- What architectural approach will be used to maintain 99.9% uptime?
- Has the organization implemented similar solutions previously?
- What risks have been identified, and how will they be mitigated?

Based on the SME discussion, the proposed solution would include:

- Automatic scaling
- High-availability architecture
- System redundancy
- Automated backups
- Failover mechanisms

Proposal Response (My submission)

The proposed system is designed to automatically scale to support up to 10,000 concurrent users while maintaining consistent performance and responsiveness. To ensure 99.9% uptime, the solution incorporates system redundancy, automated backups, and failover mechanisms that minimize service disruptions.

The architecture is built to support future business growth, handle heavy workloads efficiently, and maintain service availability during both planned maintenance and unexpected infrastructure failures.

Review

During the review process, I also recognized an important improvement opportunity: **including proof points or past performance**. While my response explained *how* the requirement would be met, a stronger proposal would also provide evidence of similar successful implementations to increase client confidence.

Skills Demonstrated

- Requirement Analysis
- Critical Thinking
- SME Collaboration
- Technical Communication
- Client-Focused Writing
- Proposal Response Development